

Punctuation reference

Punctuation mark	Name	How to use
.	period	- marks the end of a complete statement - marks the end of an abbreviated word
...	ellipsis	marks where text has been omitted or an unfinished sentence
,	comma	- follows an introductory word, phrase, or clause - can be used as parentheses, to separate a nonessential part of a sentence - can be used with a conjunction to join two main clauses - separates words or phrases in a list - represents omitted words to avoid repetition in a sentence - can be used between an introduction to speech and the direct speech
;	semicolon	- separates two main clauses that are closely related - precedes adverbs such as <i>however</i>, <i>therefore</i>, <i>consequently</i>, and <i>nevertheless</i> to connect clauses - separates items in a complex list
:	colon	- connects a main clause to a clause, phrase, or word that is an explanation of the main clause or that emphasizes a point in the main clause - introduces a list after a complete statement - introduces quoted text
'	apostrophe	- marks a missing letter - indicates possession - creates plural forms if just adding an s is confusing
-	hyphen	- links two words in compound modifiers - can be used in fractions and in numbers from twenty-one to ninety-nine - joins certain prefixes to other words
“ ”	quotation marks	- can be used before and after direct speech and quoted text - separates a word or phrase in a sentence - can be used around titles of short works
?	question mark	marks the end of a sentence that is a question
!	exclamation point	- marks the end of a sentence that expresses strong emotion - can be used at the end of an interruption to add emphasis
()	parentheses	- can be used around nonessential information in a sentence - can be used around information that provides clarification
—	dash	- can be used in pairs around interruptions - marks a range of numbers (5–6 hours) - indicates direction of travel (Trys–Qysto route)
•	bullet point	indicates a key point in a list
/	slash	can be used to show an alternative instead of using the word <i>and</i> or <i>or</i>